

Influence_Consensus_agr_div - In society, does Agriculture alone generally have a direct effect on societal Diversity (things like gender, racial, ideological, political, ethnic, etc.), or are observed relationships primarily indirect? If a direct effect exists, is it negative, none, negligible, or positive? What would be a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00? Please only provide evidence for only direct influences

Agriculture alone generally does not have a strong direct effect on societal diversity in terms of gender, racial, ideological, political, or ethnic diversity; observed relationships are primarily indirect and mediated through economic development, social structures, and policy contexts. One study found that agricultural diversity in 19th-century U.S. counties positively influenced long-run development outcomes like population density and industrial diversification, which could indirectly affect societal diversity by fostering new skills and knowledge spillovers, but it did not establish a direct causal link to societal demographic diversity (Fiszbein, 2022). Other research emphasizes that agriculture's social benefits often arise from diversification strategies that improve human well-being and food security but do not directly alter social identity categories or political/ethnic diversity (Rasmussen et al., 2024). The literature lacks evidence for a direct positive or negative effect of agriculture alone on societal diversity dimensions such as gender or ethnicity; instead, agriculture's influence is typically indirect via economic growth or social change processes (Ploeg et al., 2009). Given this absence of clear direct effects, the normalized magnitude of agriculture's direct influence on societal diversity would be close to zero (negligible), around 0.0 on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00. Thus, while agriculture can shape social conditions indirectly, there is no strong evidence supporting a direct impact on societal diversity itself (Fiszbein, 2022; Rasmussen et al., 2024; Ploeg et al., 2009).

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References

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